

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting fee earners in a busy legal environment, including a one-year placement at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner where six months were spent in a property disputes team. Experienced in document management, electronic bundling, court filings, deadline tracking, matter records and client communication. Currently managing an independent caseload at Citizens Advice East Berkshire. Strong organisational and written communication skills, with direct exposure to property and real estate litigation work.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural law and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module: 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with court filings and hearing arrangements for the property disputes team
- Maintained matter records on iManage; handled matter opening and closure; tracked deadlines across several concurrent files
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold matters and landlord and tenant disputes
- Drafted client notes and assisted with skeleton arguments and other court materials
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across competing deadlines with no supervision issues

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions as the only junior on the team ahead of a significant deadline, helping ensure on-time submission
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated external translations with a Romanian translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from initial client interview through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Q-Legal · Remote**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations and identified compliance risks; recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the submission deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and flagged provisions requiring legal input
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)**Technical skills:** Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; document review; case management and time-recording systems**Case and evidence management:** Hearing bundle preparation, matter file organisation, deadline tracking, court filings, procedural histories, document scheduling